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Part 1

Response 1: Some facts Andrews describes about photography are that it has recently begun to improve after many decades of lack of innovation. It is a technology that is becoming more and more popular, and more powerful as well. As he says on page 2, “The childhood of photography (and it has been a long one) is, however, passing away; on every side artists and educated people are working with hand and other cameras, and are astonished to find latent capabilities which they never dreamt of in the much-despised photography.” The purpose of art, according to Andrews, is to describe and recreate the world around us from our own point of view. On page 12 he writes “...the representation of nature by painting is an ideal work created by the genius of man– it is a selection of idealised forms endowed with life by means of light, shade, and color.”

Response 2: An artist differs from a machine operator in that the artist is connected to his own craft. Whether it is painting, drawing, or photography, an artist is constantly trying and seeking to improve. This is what he means by “watch and wait”, photographers only have a moment to capture what they wish to, and must be constantly seeking to get better at capturing what they wish to capture. On page 7 he writes, “...he must learn to watch and wait, and to count his failures as gain if he gets even a little nearer to his ideal.” This differs from someone who operates a machine in that there is little room for improvement for him. A machine operator can

do the same routine process all day and not improve much in their craft; the skill ceiling is much lower.

Response 3: The biggest way Andrews suggests photography assist fine art, rather than supplanting it, is through the avoidance of monotony. He specifically addresses both portraiture and landscape painting, and one of the ways he suggests avoiding monotony is through careful attention to values. On page 21, he suggests taking photographs “indoors, by or near a window” to prevent too much light from being in the picture. On page 24, for landscape paintings, he suggests practicing light and shade, specifically in the morning and evening. In doing so, an artist can capture the same subject under different lights.

Part 2

Response 1: Artistic feeling, as described by Andrews, is the passion and desire that a photographer or artist must have in order to continue to improve at their craft. In doing so, this transforms photography from the flash of a camera, or art from the stroke of a brush, into something that completely encompasses your being. An example he uses is right before the described quote where he mentions Camille Corot, a famous French painter, who would wake up early to paint.

Response 2: Art, according to Emerson, is how man views Nature and the world around him. It is an imperfect representation, but it is still a reflection of ourselves. Furthermore, the imperfection, in my view, is what makes art what it is. Man is not a perfect creature, so neither are our creations. As Andrews writes on page 27, “and all that we can do is but an aspiration after that

ideal perfection to which we may never attain." The desire to create regardless of how the end result looks is fundamental to being an artist, and is where that transformation occurs in the "alembic of man."

Response 3: Andrews calls photography a "record of plain facts" because it simply captures the image and displays it on a piece of paper. It captures all the details and perfections of its subject. On page 3 Andrews writes, "the result often is marvellously beautiful: look at the texture of rocks and fabrics of all kinds, the exquisite drawing of all natural objects, such as delicate grasses, ripple marks on sand, almost the bloom if not the colour of flowers can be caught… No human work can approach this." It differs from a painting, which Andrews argues imperfections are what makes it human, as he writes on page 26 "Imperfection in drawing and perspective, which is common to all human work."

Part 3

In the modern age, I would consider digital art to be a sister art to fine or traditional arts. I say sister, rather than cousin, because it requires a similar skill set as traditional art. I think the biggest difference would be that because digital art is not physical, you can lose the feeling of friction of a pencil or pen on paper, whereas a stylus can glide across the screen. Regardless, I know many artists who practice for many artists who possess an intimate knowledge of art theory, and have spent a great amount of time perfecting their craft.

It is for this reason that I do not consider AI-generated artwork to be in the same category as digital art, and I agree that Jason Allen cheated. The argument he uses is that it is a form of creative writing, however I find it unconvincing. It is true that writing is a skill, however, it is not

a visual medium. You write and the image is painted in the reader's mind. Communication is a skill, but no one would say I am an expert sandwich artist because I spoke my order to a Subway employee. In addition, at the risk of sounding pretentious, I think being a good writer is more than how Jason Allen describes it. He says he uses "colorful, artistic-like words like elegant, opulent, [and] lavish." However, any writer knows that those words are subjective, and their use do not convey skill on their own. What is elegant, opulent, and lavish to one person might be vulgar, ascetic, and insufficient to someone else. How something is elegant, opulent, or lavish is what a creative writer must communicate.

The inevitable comparison will be to compare this to photography, and while I think there are some interesting historical parallels, I am unconvinced by this argument for three reasons. The first reason is that, unlike photography and painting, AI-generated art has become monotonous, as Andrews cautioned photography could become. I've seen AI-generated posters, billboards, and advertisements, and they all have an unmistakable look to them. They are glossy, smooth, and often vaguely look like anime characters. The second reason is that AI is advancing at a much faster rate than photography did. In the beginning of the book, Andrews wrote about how after being around for decades, photography was only just starting to improve. This is different to AI's rate of advancement. I remember playing with DALL-E back in 2022, and just a few years later the largest companies are AI companies and its usage is widespread. It is difficult to find someone who has not used AI in some capacity, but in the late 19th century you were certain to find people who had much less experience with photographs. Perhaps this could change in the future, but for the moment I am not convinced. The last reason is that I am simply unconvinced people experience Andrews's "artistic feeling". In the book, John Andrews writes on page 8 about Jean-Baptiste-Camille Corot, and how he would wake up at three o'clock in the

morning to practice his painting. That image sticks with me because as someone who enjoys art and artmaking, the thing that I enjoy the most is the process. It doesn't matter if it is drawing, painting, or making something out of pipecleaners, the act of creation is where I get the "artistic feeling". With AI-generated art, a machine does all the work for you. You can tell it what you want the image to look like, however you did not create that image, and I do not believe people get the same enjoyment out of it as they do with actual art. This differs from photography because you decide what goes in the image. It is true that you can ask an AI to put something in the piece for you, but you still did not put it there. If you want to capture the Grand Canyon at six o'clock in the morning, you have to go and get that photograph yourself. Artificial intelligence cannot do it for you. An argument I often hear is that AI-generated artworks makes the process of artmaking more available to those who cannot make it themselves. This, too, does not convince me. Paul Alexander was the last surviving man to contract polio and need an iron lung to survive. Despite spending most of his life in an iron tube, he managed to become a lawyer and learned to paint by holding a paintbrush in his mouth. You do not need to outsource your creativity to an algorithm to be a talented artist. Jason Allen could have chosen to learn. He chose not to.